Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1868

Periods of Industry Agriculture In Mountain View
February, 1999, Meeting

The Sunday, February 7, 1999, regular quarterly meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will begin a series on *Periods of Industry* in Mountain View. In the early part of the twentieth century, Mountain View was the heart of a thriving agricultural area. Fertile soil and adequate water made for the growing of premium fruits and vegetables. The presence of packing, icing and loading facilities for the shipping of agricultural products made Mountain View the natural center of the area.

The heyday of the *Agricultural Period* was from the beginning of the century up through World War II. The February 7 program will be a panel discussion moderated by Wally Erichsen. John Viscovich will discuss orchards and cherry farming, Leo Kalcic will describe the events in a year of an apricot grower, and Ralph Faravelli will cover the truck farming activities of his family. They will all undoubtedly reminisce about some of the more memorable experiences in the life of local farmers including some that will be amusing, revealing and interesting.

After the program, plan on joining your friends and acquaintances for refreshments and good conversation.

Where It All Started Silicon Valley & The Barn
November, 1998, Meeting

Our speaker at the November, 1998 meeting was Consulting Engineer Jacques Beaudouin, one of the engineers and scientists present at the birth of *Silicon Valley*.

In 1947 William Shockley, John Bardeen and Walter Brattain developed the transistor, the basic device for the semiconductor industry. They were awarded the Nobel Prize in Physics for this work. In 1955 Shockley moved to Palo Alto and recruited a team of engineers and scientists to work for a new company, Shockley Semiconductor. Shockley opened his research and manufacturing facility in a building located at 391 San Antonio Road in Mountain View, adjacent to the San Antonio Mall. To those who worked there, the building was known as *"The Barn"*. Shockley's vision was of the commercial production transistors. He recognized the technical superiority, for commercial purposes, of silicon as the semiconductor material of choice for the fabrication of transistors.

One group of Shockley Semiconductor engineers left to form Fairchild Semiconductor, the birthplace of the integrated circuit. Nearly every semiconductor and integrated circuit company in the Bay area can likewise trace its origins to *The Barn* at 391 San

Antonio. The Electronics Industry, which was well established in the Bay Area, and two great universities provided a pool of great talent which Shockley was initially able to organize and direct.

Your automobile, your electronic coffee maker, your cellular phone, your home computer, your television set, would all be impossible in their present form without the semiconductor devices and integrated circuits which stem from work begun at *The Barn*. Without *The Barn* the area might well be known as *electron gulch*, but *Silicon Valley*, with its tens of thousands of skilled workers would be vastly different.

The Mountain View Historical Association has been asked by the Mountain View City Council to consider jointly sponsoring some sort of historical marking for *The Barn*. Our November speaker, Consulting Engineer Jacques Beaudouin, worked for several years with William Shockley at *The Barn*, and has been a long time advocate for memorializing the structure. The November meeting was an opportunity to gain some insight into the origins of what may be the most profound revolution of modern times.

William Shockley may not have been a very nice human being, but honoring William Shockley the man would not be the primary objective in memorializing *The Barn*. Rather, it would be marking the location where a very significant turn in the direction of industrialized society took place.

There is a garage in Palo Alto that is properly regarded as a memorial to the beginnings of the modern commercial electronics industry. *The Barn* is an equally important memorial to that other leg of modern technology, the commercial transistor. As an association created to record and remember the significant events in the Mountain View area, the Mountain View Historical Association should do everything we can to assist the City Council in recognizing this important historical site.

In Commemoration

James Jackson Dale, Jr. — of Nicolaus, CA, died at age 85, October 27, 1998. Born in Mountain View in 1913, a descendant of Edward Dale, who came to this area in 1850, and the son of the late James J. Dale and Eleanor (Carter) Dale. Eleanor Dale was a founder and the first President of the Mountain View Historical Association. Preceded in death by his wife Francie and sisters Dorothy Arnold and Claire Stevenson. Survived by sons William Dale and Ronald Dale, both of Nicolaus, CA. A member of the Masonic Lodge #129, the Central Sacramento Valley Shriner's, the Yuba City Moose Lodge and the Native Sons of the Golden West. He was a long time member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1899): R.M. Wyman plans to take his fast hounds, Faultless Beauty and Rush O'Hill, to Mexico and enter them in coursing races. (Coursing: The sport of chasing the hare or similar game with greyhounds who follow by sight instead of scent.)

Two local bicyclists collided early one morning on the road to Mayfield. One was killed and the other badly injured.

Six or seven carloads of wine are going out from the depot each day.

George G. Taylor has been appointed Postmaster in place of Miss Rose South, who has held the post for the last four years.

75 Years Ago (1924): Sloboda No. 2 and Sloboda Junior No. 3 are local fraternal organizations, branches of the Croatian Unity of the Pacific.

Bargains at Paulding's January clearance sale included women's flannelette gowns marked down from $1.70 to $1.40, men's cashmere sox for 35¢ and 'Perky Peggy' gingham house dresses for $1.00.



Beginning February 1 residents, for the first time, had mail delivered to their homes - two deliveries daily! Any mail without proper house numbers and streets would have to be picked up at the Post Office.

Elda Frederickson and Eleanor Levin, local students, won prizes in the nationwide writing contest sponsored by World Book for 5th through 8th graders.

Property owners along El Monte Road asked Supervisors for their road to be paved, claiming that more than 40 autos per hour on working days travel between El Camino and Fremont Road.

Minton Company purchased land between Bush Street and Calderon Avenue for a subdivision. A contract would include cost of a lot, house to be built by Minton, and landscaping. A contest to name the subdivision was won by Mrs. C.E. Kunze. She submitted "Palmita Park", named for the little new palm trees along the Bush Street end of the development. Mrs. Kunze donated her $25 prize to the Parent Teachers Association. Over 100 names were suggested in the contest.

50 Years Ago (1949): The Chamber of Commerce honored Don Luis as December, 1948 Man of the Month and Clarence Lawson was selected in February, 1949.

Kenneth Slater, Superintendent of Elementary Schools, received the Boy Scout "Oscar" for his 20 years of service to scouting.

The Calderon Shopping Center opened at Calderon Avenue and Church Street, former Jelavich property.

Signal lights were installed at El Camino Real and Castro Street.

J.A. McKelvey sold 5 acres of land to the city for use as recreation fields and an armory site. An adjoining 15 acres was purchased by the Catholic Church for an elementary school.

25 Years Ago (1974): Foothill College opened a bilingual satellite center in the Minkler Building, 257 Castro Street. Standard college classes were offered day and evenings, Monday through Friday. Hortensia Butler was coordinator and all faculty members spoke

English and a second language. For physical education credit, students could take a Mexican folk dancing class held in the Adobe Building.

Many of the 2,800 residents in the unincorporated Fremont Fire District protested that they were being blackmailed into annexation to the city with a proposed assessment for fire protection. Councilman William Jelavich was threatened with recall after stating, "If I have anything to do with it, I'm going to make the contract hurt to the point that annexation is the only solution."

New to the Mountain View History Center
Compiled by Barbara Kinchen

From Lennart Ahlkvist: Twenty one slides taken on May 4, 1975 at the dedication of the Whisman Stage Coach Marker, which stands a short distance from the main gate at Moffett Field. A number of the slides show the Wells Fargo stage coach used that afternoon for rides.

From Virgil Cooper: Copy of program of 1923 Grammar School graduation. Twenty three pictures, some from his own collection and some given him by Georgia Rogers Swall. Included are 1906 earthquake pictures of Olympic Hall and the Ames Building, interior of Burdett Blacksmith with blacksmith George Cooper, Virgil's father.

Desiree Bell: Map of Mountain View - 1956 Chamber of Commerce.

Mrs. Alan Rose: Mountain View High School Yearbooks for 1928—1931. Folder labeled Season's Greetings 1938, Eighty Second Obsn. Sq. Twelfth Obsn. Group, Air Corps, Moffett Field, California. On the cover is a picture of an airplane, on the back one of the squadron members.

Mountain View Historical Association Memorial Book

Donations have been made to:

Save the Adobe Fund

In Memory of: **Andrew Hingsberger**
From: Marge Bailey

In Memory of: **Jane Hingsberger**
From: Marge Bailey

In Memory of: **Robert K. Schatz**
From: Carmen and Ralph Faravelli
Frank and Marion Maita
Mary Lou Zoglin

The Memorial Fund

In Memory of: **Florence Wright Berger**
From: Barbara McPheeters Kinchen

In Memory of: **Stanley Thompson**
From: Edna Birkett Thompson

In Memory of: **Earl "Bud" Mockbee**
From: Eva G. Mockbee

In Memory of **Esther Wikstrom Muir**
From: Edna Birkett Thompson

In Memory of: **Clyde P. Shearer**
From: Elaine Marcetti Shearer

In Memory of: **Sam Polizzi**
From: Eva Mockbee

In Memory of: **Benny Sanches**
From: Carmen and Ralph Faravelli

In Memory of: **Kermath Lesslie**
From: Rose Lesslie

The Memorial Book may be viewed in the Mountain View History Center, at the Mountain View Library on Tuesday, Wednesday or Thursday afternoons. For information or applications please call Edna Thompson at 650-967-3116. Thank you!

Frank L. Huff
by
Kathleen Lowe Owen

When Huff School reopened after being closed for 18 years there was much local publicity about the event. Since the school has reopened, it seems appropriate to refresh our memories about Frank L. Huff.

Frank L. Huff was born in 1867 off Charleston Road near Mountain View. His parents, James and Emily Huff, had come to the Mountain View area in the early 1860's. They came from Michigan and were part of a wagon train that took five months to reach California. Most of the members of the group settled in the Napa Valley, but James and his family came to Mountain View and began farming.

After attending Whisman School and Washington College at Irvington (Fremont), Frank Huff entered the first class at Stanford University. He was head of the Department of Business at Washington College for two years, then took the teacher's examination in Santa Clara County. He taught school for six years in Boulder Creek, two years in San Jose, and 18 years at the Highway School on El Camino here in Mountain View. He was the principal of the Highway School for most of his years there.

In addition to his involvement with the local schools, Frank Huff was involved in a variety of community organizations in Mountain View. He was active in the Presbyterian Church and the Prune and Apricot Association. He also participated in the Mountain View Grange, IOOF, the Native Sons of the Golden West, the Masonic Lodge, and Kiwanis International.

After his teaching career ended, Frank Huff was appointed the postmaster in Mountain View from 1922 until 1934. He received his appointment from President Warren G. Harding. After retiring from this position, Frank Huff continued to farm his prune orchard on Levin Avenue in Mountain View until his death.

In 1938 Frank Huff was killed in a train accident at Rengstorff Avenue. He was killed instantly when his car was struck by a southbound Southern Pacific locomotive as he was crossing the tracks. To commemorate his service to the local school district, an elementary school was dedicated in his honor in 1958.



SAVE THE ADOBE

Editor's Ramblings

Flora and I moved to Mountain View in January, 1982. This Mountain View home is our fourteenth, and this seventeen year residence is the longest we have ever spent in one house in our forty-eight years together. I became interested in the Historical Association while doing some research prior to the construction of our neighborhood Gemello Park.

I was given the opportunity to become Editor of this Newsletter when Mary Lentz decided after seven years as Editor to move on to other challenges. This issue is the twenty second under my auspices, the second issue in my sixth year as Editor. In my first issue I said:

I want to use the office of Editor to forward the aims of the Association. I take these to be: to make us more aware of the richness of our culture and heritage, to support the institutions and activities which will make Mountain View a more culturally rich and diverse place, and to speak out boldly on issues which run counter to the aims (as I see and interpret them) of the Association.

Mary Lentz and I have had, up until this issue, a common problem. Finding enough space in each issue for all of the articles and announcements needing to be published. This time I found myself with a whole page needing to be filled. I've decided to review my incumbency and try to see how well or ill I have performed against those goals.

To begin with, aside from Barbara Kinchen who can always be relied upon to deliver interesting material on a timely basis, the staff of the Mountain View Library has been amazingly prescient in identifying issues. The staff gave us an article on Shockley Semiconductor in November of 1993, a topic which 'turned hot' in 1998. The staff described the Adobe Building in November of 1994, which 'turned hot' in 1996. The staff has also delivered interesting and timely sketches of prominent residents Maxwell, Slater, Stevens, Kennedy, Bruner, and Askam. Altogether, a total of twenty articles from the Library Staff, in the twenty-two issues I have edited. The Newsletter has featured the history of the El Camino Hospital, the Fire Department, the Police Department, the Shockley Semiconductor Barn, the Adobe Building, the Peralta Adobe, the Pioneer Cemetery and earthquake preparedness.

Let me strike a bargain with all you who have any interest in the Newsletter. Send me articles, and if they are relevant I'll edit and publish. Send me notes and references, and if they are relevant, I will write them up. In short, I welcome the participation of anyone in the community who has something relevant to say.

Beyond just the editorial content of the Newsletter, I welcome comments and suggestions about layout, composition and content. Anything which will help make this a more interesting and attractive package for our readers.

I'm reasonably satisfied with what we have done. I strive to do better in the future. In the mean time, you see what happens when you don't feed me enough material, so get busy!

Street Talk

The November, 1998 *Street Talk Puzzler* was: *Cousins, Margaret Sharp Peterson and George Holden, lived for a number of years on Main Street. This is now incorporated into which expressway?* Your Editor had never before noticed that Mountain View is a town without a Main Street!

The answer for the November puzzler is: Main Street was on the north side and parallel to the train tracks and ran east from the Castro Street crossing only to Stevens Creek. West from the same crossing was Alma Street. Now, both streets are incorporated into the Central Expressway.

For this issue the *Street Talk Puzzler* is: *Until 1930 Alma Street had a different name. What was it?*

Membership Report
by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	61
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Individual & Family Members	219
Total	282

New Members:

Robert A. Beck: Frances M. Mills (Chardin)
Barbara A. Regallo (Seal): Elias Ochoa
William Dale: Lorris Watson

New Life Members:

Ed Henderson: Doris Ebere (Awalt)
Harold Jarvis

Life Members

Mario Ambra
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Dena K. Bonnell
Hilton Brown
Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo
Alfred P. Chasuk
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Ed Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Anne G. Nichols
Milan Popovich
John P. Puppo
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President & Program	John Viscovich
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorial/Remembrance	Margaret Peterson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Treasurer's Report
A.J. de Larios

October 1, 1998 - December 31, 1998

Balance 10/1/98		**$ 11,813.19**
Income		
Membership	$ 761.00	
Sales	84.60	
Small Brewers Festival	585.00	
Interest	3.60	
Total Income		1432.20
Expenses		
Administration	$ 241.83	
Service Charge	36.00	
Total Expenses		277.83
Balance 12/31/98		**$ 12,969.56**
Fund Balances		
Adobe Fund	$ 2,604.32	
Memorial Fund	275.00	
Life Member Fund	6,100.00	
General Fund	2,969.24	
Total Funds		**$ 12,969.56**

Investment

C.D. $10,000 — 5.40% — Matures 7/99

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
REGULAR MEETING

Sunday, February 7, 1999
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

A Panel Presentation

Periods of Industry Agriculture in Mtn. View

Moderator: Wally Erichsen
Panelists: John Viscovich, Leo Kalcic and Ralph Faravelli

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
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